Motionholic

INDUSTRY RESEARCH REPORT · OCTOBER 2026

The Consultancy Industry Problems and Content Solutions

What consulting firms are struggling with right now, and what to publish, produce and measure to fix it. 8 problems, 24 solutions and a 30-day demo content plan.

Prepared by Motionholic · motionholic.com

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Executive summary

Consulting is not shrinking. Mordor Intelligence puts global management consulting revenue at $374.67 billion in 2026, growing toward $471 billion by 2031. What is changing is who wins the work, how it is priced, and what buyers need to see before they trust a firm. This report maps the eight biggest problems consultancies are facing right now and gives at least three content-led solutions for each.

$374.7B
Global management consulting revenue, 2026 (Mordor, via HybridHero)

94%
B2B buyers who fact-check AI research (TrustRadius 2026)

37%
Mid-sized firms planning fractional executives by mid-2026, up from 12% in 2020 (High5)

15–20%
Industry-wide attrition (Mordor, via HybridHero)

The eight problems at a glance

1. **Commoditization: AI makes every deck look the same**
   When research, analysis and first drafts take hours instead of weeks, polished output stops being a differentiator.
2. **Pricing pressure: hourly billing is getting harder to defend**
   Clients want faster work, measurable results and fixed or outcome-linked fees, and the supply of talent willing to underprice days has surged.
3. **Margin and utilization squeeze**
   Revenue per consultant is under pressure while scope creep and overhead quietly eat profit.
4. **The talent squeeze: scarce AI skills, shrinking junior pipelines**
   Firms pay a premium for AI specialists while automation reshapes what junior consultants do.
5. **The trust deficit: buyers verify everything**
   In an AI-saturated market, buyers fact-check, discount claims, and ask for evidence before they shortlist.
6. **New rivals: boutiques, independents and fractional talent**
   Specialists and flexible talent models are taking share, and mid-sized generalists feel it most.
7. **Demand volatility and invisible expertise**
   Feast-or-famine pipelines hit firms whose best experts are not visible to the market.
8. **The implementation gap: clients want AI value, not AI advice**
   Clients are adopting AI fast but struggling to see returns, and they expect consultants to show how.

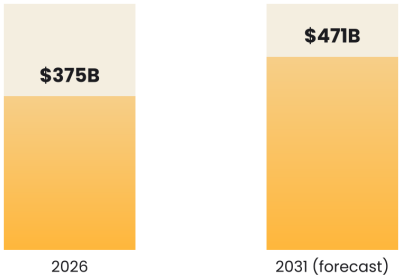
The common thread: as AI makes polished output cheap, buyers pay for judgment they can verify. Content that carries original insight, visible experts and real proof is the most direct way to show it.

Industry snapshot

Demand is healthy but the mix is moving: away from generalist advice and toward AI implementation, governance, niche specialists and flexible talent.

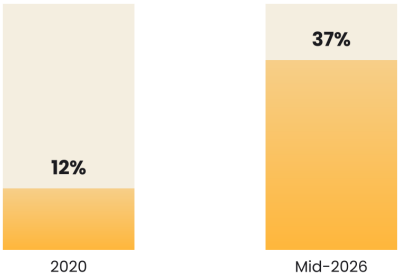
Global management consulting revenue

Mordor Intelligence, via HybridHero (Oct 2026)



Mid-sized firms using fractional / interim executives

High5 Business Transformation & Independent Talent Report 2026



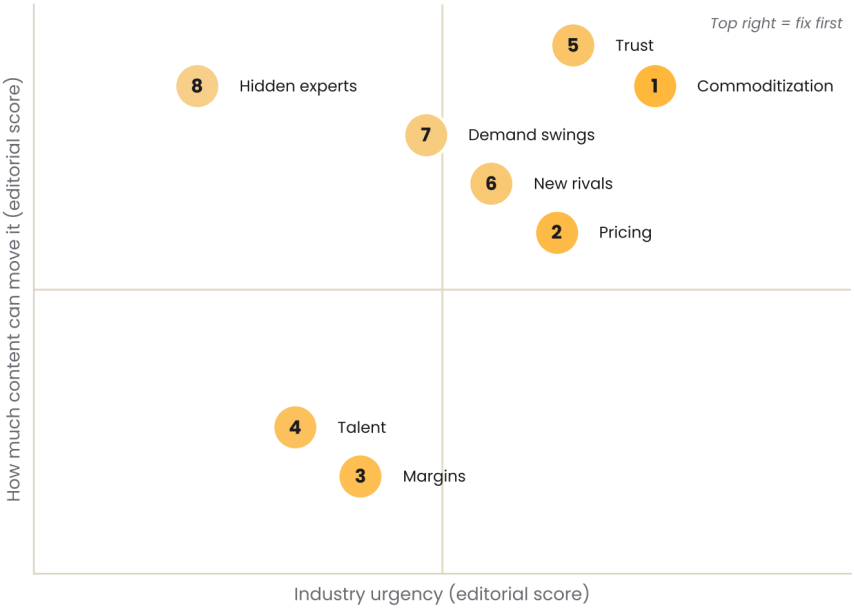
Forces shaping the market in 2026

- **AI moves from experiment to production.** Implementation is the largest slice (about 35%) of the AI consulting market, and 75% of enterprises plan to raise AI budgets by 20% or more in 2026 (Data Insights Reports).
- **Specialists are surging.** Clients in cybersecurity and digital banking prioritize acute industry knowledge, which diminishes generalist appeal (WebProNews).
- **Outcomes over activity.** Clients recalibrating budgets after the 2025 layoffs want measurable outcomes and agile, tech-infused services (WebProNews).
- **Independents and boutiques gain ground.** They win on flexibility, niche expertise and lower price points, and AI-native boutiques need fewer junior analysts (AlphaSense).
- **Compliance and ESG add weight.** Regulatory and reputation risk now affects both clients and consulting firms (NMS Consulting).
- **Demand is uneven.** Outlook is mixed but generally positive, with margin pressure, talent constraints and outcome-based commercial models (NMS Consulting).

Figures come from secondary industry sources and vendor research; see the method note on the final pages.

Problem map

Where each problem sits on urgency and on how much content can move it. Scores are Motionholic editorial judgments based on the evidence in this report, not survey results.



#	Problem	Headline evidence	Primary content lever
1	Commoditization	Weeks-to-hours AI compression	Original POV and data
2	Pricing pressure	Day rates -15% (6 mo. to Jan 2026)	Outcome proof and pricing education
3	Margins and utilization	Revenue/consultant $199K (2024)	Scope kit and bench-to-pipeline
4	Talent squeeze	28% AI-specialist premium	Employer brand and expert visibility
5	Trust deficit	94% fact-check AI research	Video proof and transparency
6	New rivals	Fractional use 12% to 37%	Niche authority and partners
7	Demand and visibility	11.0% of revenue into marketing at top firms	Always-on engine and SME activation
8	Implementation gap	88% use AI, 80%+ see no impact	Roadmaps and pilot proof

PROBLEM 1

Commoditization: AI makes every deck look the same

When research, analysis and first drafts take hours instead of weeks, polished output stops being a differentiator.

What is happening

For decades, consultancies differentiated on their ability to gather, synthesize and structure information under time pressure. Generative AI has collapsed that barrier. Research synthesis, financial modelling, documentation and first-draft strategy are now produced faster, and by more firms, at similar quality.

The result is a crisis of differentiation. Deliverables are becoming comparable across firms, and some clients are already asking for AI-driven discounts. Meanwhile AI labs are reported to be aiming directly at the roughly $1 trillion management consulting market, so the competitor set is widening, not just the competition.

Weeks to hours

How far AI has compressed research, analysis and first-draft work (Chief Reinvention Officer, 2026)

~$1T

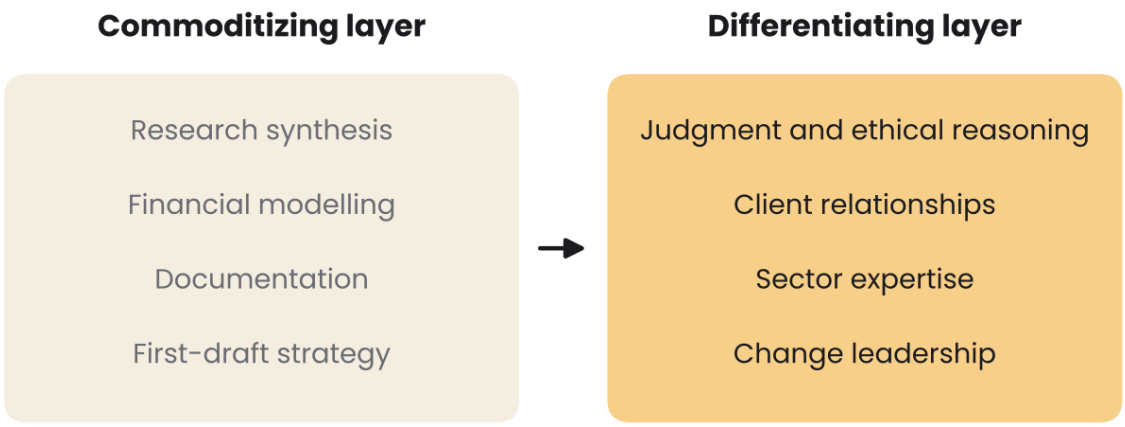
Management consulting market AI labs are reported to be targeting (The Telegraph, May 2026, via WhitehatSEO)

Entry level

Analytical roles such as synthesis, modelling and documentation face the greatest disruption (WhitehatSEO, 2026)

Why it hurts

- Generic claims make even large firms sound like their smaller peers, which erodes pricing power.
- Buyers cannot tell which firm actually has the judgment, only which has the nicest slides.
- As AI lowers the cost of content, firms publish more, so average content quality and trust fall together.



Solutions for problem 1

Content-led plays Motionholic recommends. Each includes steps, formats, effort and what to measure.

1.1 Own a named point of view

AI can summarize what is known. It cannot decide what your firm stands for. A recurring, opinionated POV series turns your judgment into a visible asset.

How to run it

1. Pick three stances your firm will defend that a model could not derive from public data.
2. Back each with one real client story and one number.
3. Publish monthly as an essay, then cut a 60 to 90 second founder video from the same script.

Formats: LinkedIn essay, founder video, newsletter **Effort:** Medium **Track:** Inbound leads quoting your POV; branded search growth

1.2 Publish original data

Proprietary data and primary research produce insight that generic AI output cannot match, which is why firms that lean on it keep an edge.

How to run it

1. Survey 100+ buyers in your niche, or aggregate anonymized client benchmarks.
2. Release one flagship report, then five data-point clips and a launch webinar.
3. Refresh annually so the report becomes a reference people cite.

Formats: Report, data clips, webinar **Effort:** High **Track:** Citations and backlinks; report downloads to meetings booked

1.3 Name and visualize your method

A named framework with a clear visual is hard to copy and easy to remember. Animated explainers make complex methods feel owned and proprietary.

How to run it

1. Turn your delivery approach into a 3 to 5 step named framework.
2. Design a single signature diagram and animate it as a 45 second explainer.
3. Reuse the explainer in proposals, decks, and sales emails.

Formats: Motion-graphic explainer, framework one-pager **Effort:** Medium **Track:** Proposal win rate; time-to-understand in first calls

PROBLEM 2

Pricing pressure: hourly billing is getting harder to defend

Clients want faster work, measurable results and fixed or outcome-linked fees, and the supply of talent willing to underprice days has surged.

What is happening

AI is making hourly fees harder to justify: if a task takes a tenth of the time, clients ask why the invoice does not shrink. At the same time, the market for senior transformation talent has been flooded. Practitioner commentary citing the Institute of Interim Management reports median day rates for business improvement roles falling about 15% year on year in the six months to January 2026, while posting volumes held steady, which is the signature of a repriced market rather than a shrinking one.

Moving to fixed-fee or outcome-based pricing can win work, but it transfers delivery risk to the firm and demands much tighter scoping. Firms that cannot explain the value of their price lose the argument by default.

-15%
Median day-rate change for business improvement roles, six months to Jan 2026 (IIM survey, via practitioner post)

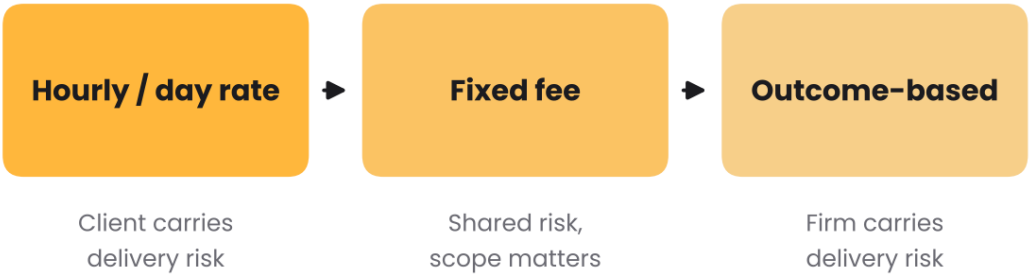
11,000+
Accenture roles cut in a 90-day period disclosed Sept 2025, adding to a wave of available talent (practitioner post)

Risk shift
Fixed-fee and outcome pricing move delivery risk onto the firm (HiBob, 2026)

Why it hurts

- Hourly pricing puts you in a direct race against freelancers and AI tools on the same unit.
- Discounting becomes the default negotiation lever when value is not documented.
- Outcome-based contracts without tight scope can turn a win into a margin loss.

The pricing ladder clients are pushing firms up



Solutions for problem 2

Content-led plays Motionholic recommends. Each includes steps, formats, effort and what to measure.

2.1 Outcome-led case studies with real numbers

Buyers decide on proof of outcomes, not promises. A case study with before/after numbers lets you anchor the price conversation on results instead of effort.

How to run it

1. Choose your three best outcomes and get client approval to share metrics.
2. Produce each as a 90 second video with the numbers on screen plus a one-page written version.
3. Attach the relevant case to every proposal that mentions price.

Formats: Video case study, one-pager **Effort:** Medium **Track:** Discount frequency; proposal win rate

2.2 Pricing explainer and ROI calculator

Educate buyers on how value-based pricing works so the conversation shifts from rate cards to return on investment.

How to run it

1. Write a plain-language guide: what you charge for, what you guarantee, what is out of scope.
2. Build a simple ROI calculator with two or three inputs.
3. Add a short video walk-through and link it from your proposal template.

Formats: Guide, interactive calculator, explainer video **Effort:** Medium **Track:** Calculator completions; deals closed on fixed or outcome terms

2.3 Productized offers with fixed scope

A packaged offer with a clear deliverable, timeline and price is harder to compare against an hourly rate.

How to run it

1. Convert your top two repeat engagements into named packages.
2. Create a dedicated page and a 60 second walkthrough for each.
3. Show a sample deliverable so the buyer can see exactly what the fee buys.

Formats: Offer pages, walkthrough videos, sample deliverables **Effort:** Low **Track:** Share of revenue from packaged offers; sales-cycle length

PROBLEM 3

Margin and utilization squeeze

Revenue per consultant is under pressure while scope creep and overhead quietly eat profit.

What is happening

Utilization drives consulting profitability, but keeping it healthy is hard. Deltek's benchmarks put revenue per consultant at $199,000 in 2024, a sign that margin pressure persists even as firms chase higher utilization. Healthy gross margins range between 40 and 60 percent, and where a firm lands in that range depends heavily on pricing discipline and delivery efficiency.

Scope creep on fixed-fee engagements and eroding utilization are two of the most damaging and most underestimated threats. In AI consulting specifically, strategy work holds margins around 45 to 50 percent, while implementation work faces erosion as clients demand fixed-price contracts.

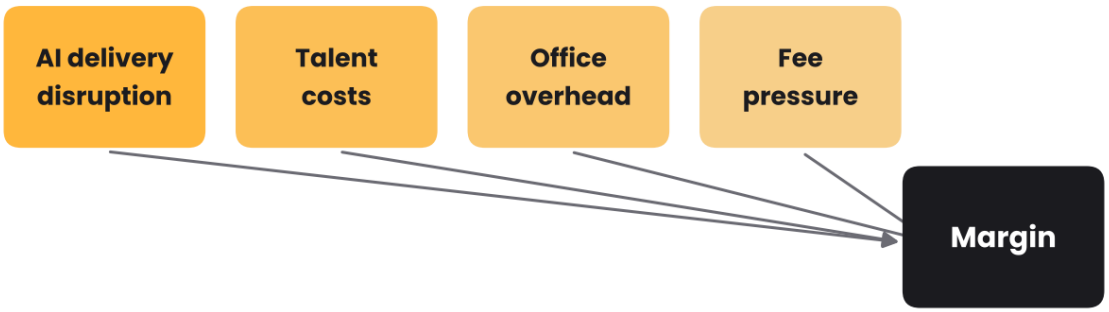
$199K
Revenue per consultant in 2024 (Deltek Professional Services Benchmarks, via HiBob)

40-60%
Healthy gross-margin range for consulting firms (HiBob, 2026)

45-50%
Margins in AI strategy consulting, versus eroding margins in fixed-price implementation (Data Insights Reports)

Why it hurts

- Every unbilled bench week and every unmanaged change request lands directly on profit.
- Senior time is spent re-explaining the same concepts to every new client.
- Four forces compress margins at once: AI delivery disruption, talent cost, overhead, and fee pressure (HybridHero, 2026).



Four forces compress consulting margins at the same time (HybridHero, 2026)

Solutions for problem 3

Content-led plays Motionholic recommends. Each includes steps, formats, effort and what to measure.

3.1 Scope-guardrail content kit

Most scope creep starts with unclear expectations. A standard kit sets them before the engagement begins.

How to run it

1. Record a 3 minute client-onboarding video explaining scope, assumptions and the change-request process.
2. Create a one-page 'in scope / out of scope' template.
3. Send both in the kickoff email and refer back to them whenever new asks appear.

Formats: Onboarding video, scope template, change-request form **Effort:** Low **Track:** Change requests billed; write-offs per project

3.2 Turn bench time into pipeline

Low-utilization weeks are the cheapest time to produce content that fills the next quarter.

How to run it

1. Keep a standing content backlog of case studies, explainers and interview clips.
2. When utilization dips, assign consultants to a two-day content sprint.
3. Publish across the weeks that follow so output stays steady while client work is busy.

Formats: Content sprints, evergreen backlog **Effort:** Low **Track:** Utilization variance; inbound leads per quarter

3.3 Self-serve knowledge assets

Reusable explainers cut the repeated hours consultants spend answering the same questions.

How to run it

1. List the ten questions every client asks.
2. Answer each with a short video or one-page guide hosted in a client hub.
3. Point clients to the hub during delivery instead of scheduling extra calls.

Formats: Short explainer videos, client hub, FAQ **Effort:** Medium **Track:** Non-billable hours per engagement; client satisfaction

PROBLEM 4

The talent squeeze: scarce AI skills, shrinking junior pipelines

Firms pay a premium for AI specialists while automation reshapes what junior consultants do.

What is happening

Industry-wide attrition is estimated at 15 to 20 percent. At the same time, an estimated one million AI roles went unfilled globally in 2025, pushing firms to pay a salary premium of about 28 percent above standard technology roles for AI practitioners. Entry-level starting salaries held flat in 2026 for the fourth time in 16 years, so the premium is concentrated in a small specialist pool.

The classic pyramid is also under strain. Large firms have cut roles, and AI is automating much of the analytical work juniors used to learn on. Management Consulted notes that attrition remains below historical averages and that hiring is expected to rise as demand recovers, so competition for good people is likely to intensify in 2026 and 2027.

15-20%
Industry-wide attrition (Mordor Intelligence, via HybridHero)

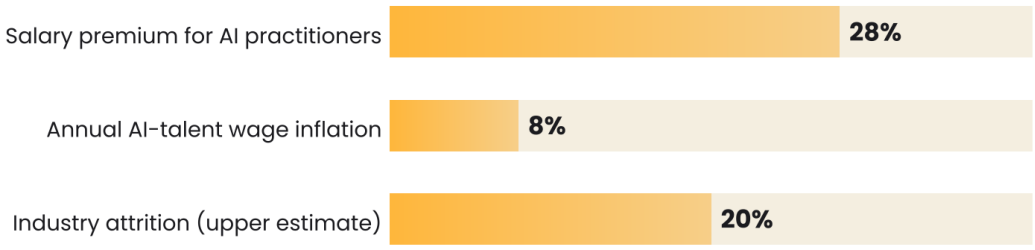
28%
Salary premium for AI practitioners over standard tech roles (Rise 2026, via HybridHero)

1M
Unfilled AI roles globally in 2025 (Data Insights Reports)

Why it hurts

- Replacing a consultant costs far more than the salary alone, and the ramp-up eats utilization.
- AI specialists push labour costs up and compress margins by an estimated 5 to 7 percent in AI consulting (Data Insights Reports).
- If juniors no longer learn on analytical grunt work, firms need new ways to build judgment.

Talent cost pressure
Rise 2026 / Data Insights Reports / Mordor Intelligence, as cited



Solutions for problem 4

Content-led plays Motionholic recommends. Each includes steps, formats, effort and what to measure.

4.1 Employer-brand video: real work, real people

Candidates choose firms they can picture themselves at. Short authentic content beats a careers page.

How to run it

1. Film a 'day in the life' series with five consultants at different levels.
2. Add 'what I learned on my last project' clips from recent hires.
3. Distribute on LinkedIn and embed them in every job posting.

Formats: Short video series, job-post embeds **Effort:** Low **Track:** Application quality; offer acceptance rate

4.2 Internal academy of micro-learning

A library of bite-sized lessons on AI-augmented workflows shortens ramp-up and shows staff a visible development path.

How to run it

1. Record your best consultants walking through how they actually use AI on real tasks.
2. Organize them into a 10 to 15 lesson onboarding path.
3. Update quarterly and credit contributors by name.

Formats: Screen-recorded tutorials, playbooks **Effort:** Medium **Track:** Time to first billable project; 12-month retention

4.3 Make your experts visible

Consultants who build a public profile feel invested in, and their visibility brings both clients and candidates.

How to run it

1. Offer every senior consultant a light-touch content plan: one idea a month, turned into a post and a clip by the content team.
2. Share their writing from the firm account.
3. Feature rising talent in your newsletter.

Formats: Ghost-assisted posts, clips, newsletter features **Effort:** Medium **Track:** Voluntary attrition; inbound candidates from referrals

PROBLEM 5

The trust deficit: buyers verify everything

In an AI-saturated market, buyers fact-check, discount claims, and ask for evidence before they shortlist.

What is happening

TrustRadius's 2026 B2B Buying Disconnect report finds that 94 percent of B2B buyers fact-check AI research outputs. Forrester's Buyers' Journey Survey 2025 found that 19 percent of business buyers were less confident in a purchase because AI systems gave inaccurate or misleading results, and Forrester predicts evidence of success will outweigh brand prestige in 2026.

Buyers also express deep skepticism toward ROI projections and sales engagement. Trust in consultants and subject-matter experts, at 59 percent, trails coworkers, third-party opinions and referrals. That gap is both a problem and an opening: firms that systematically publish verifiable proof can move ahead of firms that only make claims.

94%
B2B buyers who fact-check AI research outputs (TrustRadius 2026, via MarketScale)

19%
Business buyers less confident in a purchase due to misleading AI output (Forrester, 2025)

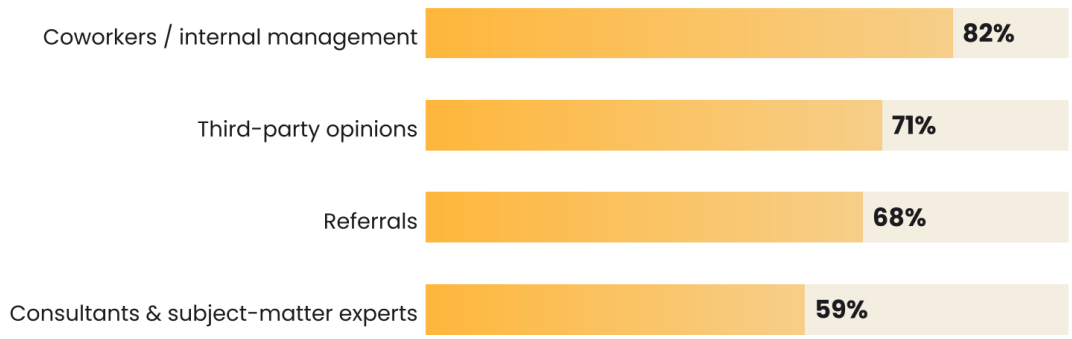
78%
Buyers who pick a vendor they had already heard of before starting research (Search Engine Journal)

Why it hurts

- Claims without evidence are discounted, or filtered out by buyers' own AI tools.
- Trust has to exist before shortlists form, which happens before sales is involved.
- Generic proof points no longer persuade; buyers want to see their own industry, size and use case.

Where B2B buyers place their trust

Search Engine Journal, B2B trust deficit analysis (2026)



Solutions for problem 5

Content-led plays Motionholic recommends. Each includes steps, formats, effort and what to measure.

5.1 Proof-first video case studies

Seeing a real client explain a real result builds more confidence than a polished testimonial quote.

How to run it

1. Interview the client, not the consultant, for 8 to 10 minutes.
2. Cut a 90 second headline version with the key metric on screen, and keep the long cut for deep evaluation.
3. Match cases to buyer segments so each prospect sees their own context.

Formats: Client interview video, written case, metrics card

Effort: Medium

Track: Case-study views before first call; win rate on influenced deals

5.2 Publish your method and your AI policy

Transparency about how work is done and how AI output is verified turns a buyer's skepticism into confidence.

How to run it

1. Write a plain-English page: how we work, how we use AI, how we check it, what we do not do.
2. Add assumptions and sources to every published number.
3. Link the page from proposals and the website footer.

Formats: Trust page, methodology PDF, explainer video

Effort: Low

Track: Security and procurement questions closed faster; sales-cycle length

5.3 Third-party and peer validation hub

Buyers trust third-party opinions and referrals more than your own claims, so collect them in one place.

How to run it

1. Build a single page with reviews, analyst or press mentions, awards, and client logos with permission.
2. Host quarterly client panel webinars where peers answer buyer questions.
3. Create a short unified trust summary that sales can send before a first call.

Formats: Proof hub, panel webinars, trust summary document

Effort: Medium

Track: Share of leads who arrive pre-warmed; reference-call volume

PROBLEM 6

New rivals: boutiques, independents and fractional talent

Specialists and flexible talent models are taking share, and mid-sized generalists feel it most.

What is happening

By mid-2026, 37 percent of mid-sized firms planned to use fractional or interim executives, up from 12 percent in 2020, according to High5's 2026 report. Deltek's research found that 21 percent of management consultancies and 22 percent of IT firms had already lost work to independents, and both groups fear boutiques most. Independent consultants account for about 10 percent of the UK's management consulting industry.

Mid-sized solution firms feel squeezed from both sides: dominant global firms on one end, and agile, niche, lower-priced specialists on the other. Clients also compare alternatives like insourcing and commoditized solution providers, so the competitor list is wider than other consultancies.

12% to 37%
Mid-sized firms planning fractional or interim executives, 2020 to mid-2026 (High5)

21-22%
Consultancies that lost work to independents (Deltek via Consultancy.uk)

~10%
Independents' share of the UK management consulting industry (Consultancy.uk)

Why it hurts

- Generalist positioning loses to specialist expertise, especially in AI governance, cybersecurity, and sector niches.
- Smaller rivals compete on flexibility and price, and AI-native boutiques need fewer junior analysts.
- Clients may assemble pods of independents rather than hire a whole firm.

Work already leaking to independents
Deltek study via Consultancy.uk



Solutions for problem 6

Content-led plays Motionholic recommends. Each includes steps, formats, effort and what to measure.

6.1 Own a niche with sector-by-problem content

Specialists win because buyers believe they understand a specific problem deeply. Content is the fastest way to prove that depth.

How to run it

1. Choose two or three sector-by-problem combinations where you already have client results.
2. Build a dedicated landing page for each, supported by five to ten articles and clips.
3. Answer the exact questions buyers ask, in their vocabulary.

Formats: Landing pages, SEO articles, short video answers **Effort:** Medium **Track:** Organic rankings on niche terms; qualified inbound per niche

6.2 Coopetition content with partners

Competition is shifting toward structured collaboration. Co-created content positions you as the orchestrator of a trusted network.

How to run it

1. Select three complementary boutiques or independents.
2. Co-host a webinar and co-author a joint report.
3. Present the partner network on a dedicated page, so buyers see breadth without losing specialist depth.

Formats: Joint webinar, co-authored report, partner page **Effort:** Medium **Track:** Partner-sourced pipeline; joint deals won

6.3 Show your delivery model

Flexibility is a main reason clients pick smaller rivals. Make your own agility visible.

How to run it

1. Explain on video how a typical two-week sprint works, who is on the team, and what the client gets each week.
2. Publish pod and team structures openly.
3. Add a 'start small' offer for hesitant buyers.

Formats: Process explainer, team page, starter-offer page **Effort:** Low **Track:** Time to first meeting; conversion on starter offer

PROBLEM 7

Demand volatility and invisible expertise

Feast-or-famine pipelines hit firms whose best experts are not visible to the market.

What is happening

Hinge Research Institute found market unpredictability has been the consulting industry's top concern for four years running. Firms that rely on referrals and relationships alone feel every downturn immediately. By contrast, the 2026 High Growth Study shows top-performing firms invest 11.0 percent of revenue in marketing, more than twice as much as no-growth firms, and prioritize thought leadership and original research.

Visibility matters because buyers form shortlists before talking to anyone. The same study finds high-growth firms are 55 percent more likely to have highly active subject-matter experts, and an earlier Grist study reports that 73 percent of executives would look at competitors if their advisor was not producing thought leadership. Hinge's findings are correlational, so they show what top firms do, not proof of cause.

4 years
Market unpredictability named top industry concern (Hinge Research, via HiBob)

11.0%
Share of revenue high-growth firms invest in marketing, over twice no-growth firms (Hinge, 2026)

55%
Likelihood advantage for top firms to have highly active subject-matter experts (Hinge, 2026)

Why it hurts

- A referral-only pipeline cannot be switched on when demand drops.
- Experts who never publish are invisible to buyers and to AI search.
- Many leads are not ready to buy immediately, so firms that stop at the first call lose them.

Thought leadership is now a buying criterion
Grist study, cited by The Visible Authority (2024 data)



Solutions for problem 7

Content-led plays Motionholic recommends. Each includes steps, formats, effort and what to measure.

7.1 An always-on content engine

Consistent publishing compounds into a pipeline that does not depend on any single referral.

How to run it

1. Commit to a weekly newsletter, two LinkedIn posts, and one short video per week.
2. Budget marketing deliberately rather than from leftover time.
3. Review monthly, retire what does not produce conversations, and double down on what does.

Formats: Newsletter, LinkedIn posts, short-form video **Effort:** Medium **Track:** Inbound inquiries per month; share of pipeline from content

7.2 Activate your subject-matter experts

Your experts hold the insights. A light process turns each conversation into several assets without asking them to write.

How to run it

1. Run a 20 minute interview with one expert every two weeks.
2. Turn each into a long-form clip, three short clips, a LinkedIn post and an article draft.
3. Credit the expert and route replies back to them.

Formats: Expert interviews cut into video, posts, articles **Effort:** Medium **Track:** Active experts publishing; assets per interview

7.3 Nurture not-yet-ready buyers

Many leads need time. Education-first nurturing keeps your firm top of mind until a budget opens.

How to run it

1. Map content to stages: awareness (problem), consideration (options), decision (proof and risk).
2. Set up a five to seven email sequence triggered by a download or webinar.
3. Add a 'cost of inaction' piece for stalled opportunities.

Formats: Email sequences, webinars, cost-of-inaction guide **Effort:** Low **Track:** Lead-to-meeting conversion; reactivated opportunities

PROBLEM 8

The implementation gap: clients want AI value, not AI advice

Clients are adopting AI fast but struggling to see returns, and they expect consultants to show how.

What is happening

Secondary reports citing McKinsey's 2025 research say 88 percent of companies are using AI, yet more than 80 percent report no bottom-line impact. That gap is where consulting demand is moving. AI implementation now accounts for the largest revenue share, about 35 percent, of the AI consulting market as clients shift from planning to execution, and Gartner expects 40 percent of enterprise applications to feature task-specific AI agents by the end of 2026, up from under 5 percent in 2025.

As AI moves into production, the question changes from what AI can do to how it is governed and controlled, creating new demand for compliance and risk work. The risk is that firms who sell strategy decks lose ground to those who show working results, especially because implementation margins erode under fixed-price pressure.

88% / 80%+

Companies using AI versus those with no bottom-line impact (McKinsey 2025, via WebProNews)

35%

AI implementation's share of AI consulting revenue (Data Insights Reports)

40%

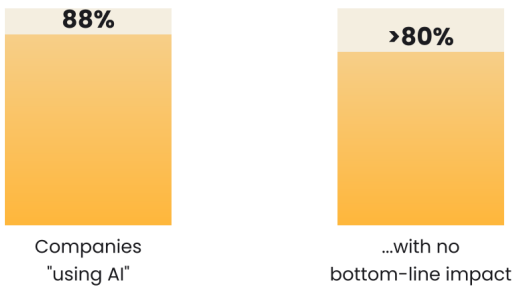
Enterprise apps expected to feature task-specific AI agents by end of 2026, from <5% in 2025 (Gartner, via Enki.AI)

Why it hurts

- Strategy-only offers look thin when clients want production-scale results.
- Governance, risk and compliance questions are growing and need clear, trusted answers.
- Without evidence of working implementations, buyers default to vendors who can show them.

The AI value gap clients want help closing

McKinsey 2025 figures as cited by WebProNews (secondary source)



Solutions for problem 8

Content-led plays Motionholic recommends. Each includes steps, formats, effort and what to measure.

8.1 Implementation roadmaps and teardown content

Move beyond 'we helped them grow' to the exact roadmap and ROI that produced the result.

How to run it

1. Document three engagements as step-by-step roadmaps: starting point, decisions, pitfalls, results.
2. Publish each as a long-form case study and a 3 minute walkthrough video.
3. Keep the detail high enough that a buyer can imagine doing it themselves, and then hiring you to do it faster.

Formats: Long-form case study, walkthrough video, roadmap PDF **Effort:** High **Track:** Qualified meetings from case studies; deal size

8.2 AI readiness and governance education

Demand for governance, compliance and risk guidance is rising. Educational content positions you as the safe pair of hands.

How to run it

1. Publish an AI-governance checklist and a short readiness self-assessment.
2. Run a monthly live workshop on one control, risk, or regulation topic.
3. Offer a follow-up review to every attendee who scores low.

Formats: Checklist, self-assessment, live workshops **Effort:** Medium **Track:** Assessment completions; workshop-to-meeting conversion

8.3 Pilot proof clips

Trials and pilots have become a key proof point, and buyers switch providers after unsatisfactory ones. Show yours working.

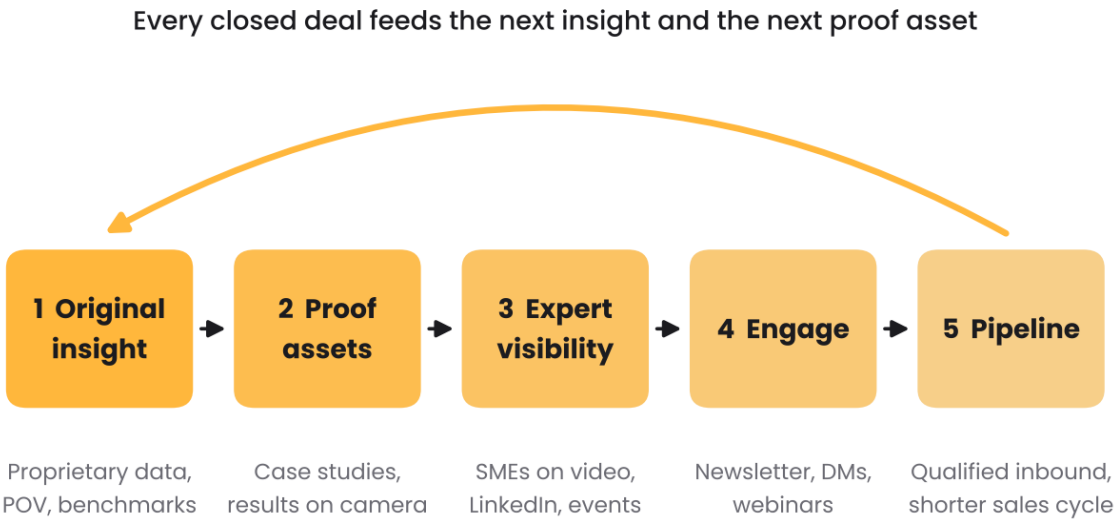
How to run it

1. Record short before/after screen captures from each pilot with client permission.
2. Share weekly progress in a 60 second update video during the pilot.
3. Package the best into a 'pilot results' reel for sales.

Formats: Screen-capture clips, weekly update videos, results reel **Effort:** Medium **Track:** Pilot-to-contract conversion; proposal win rate

Putting it together: the content flywheel

The 24 playbooks are not 24 separate projects. They reinforce one another: original insight creates proof, proof creates expert visibility, visibility creates conversations, and conversations become pipeline and new insight.



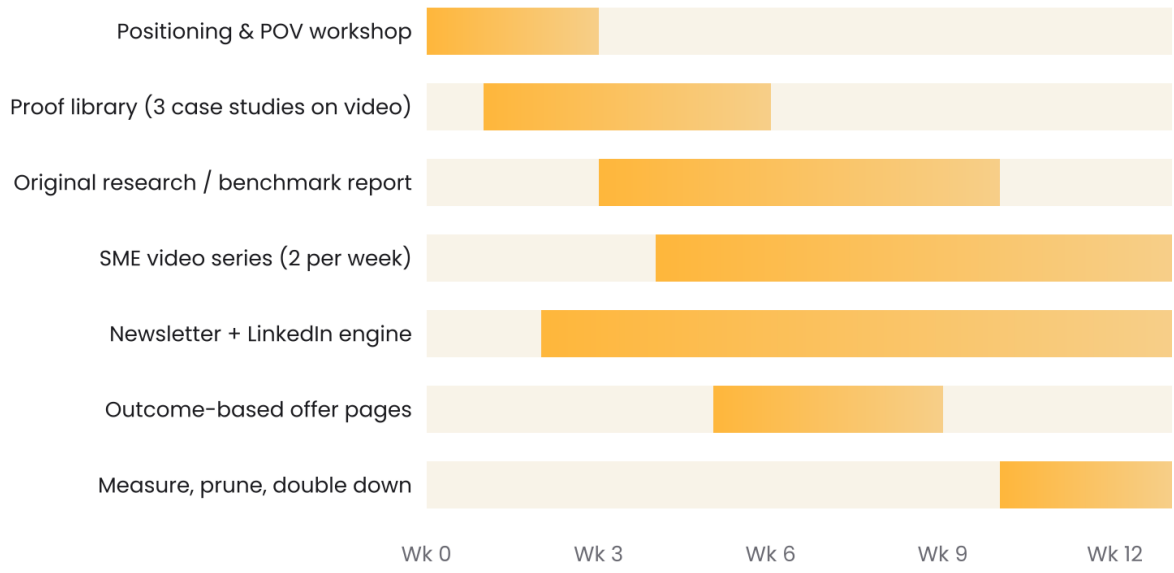
The Motionholic proof-led content flywheel

Where to start

- **Start with proof.** Three video case studies fix problems 2, 5 and 8 at once.
- **Add one expert-led series.** It addresses problems 1, 4, 6 and 7 together.
- **Publish one flagship dataset.** It is the hardest to copy and compounds for years.
- **Measure monthly and prune.** Keep what produces conversations; drop the rest.

A 12-week starter roadmap

A suggested sequence for a firm starting from a thin content base. Timings are a Motionholic recommendation and should flex with team size.



What to measure

Layer	Metric	Why it matters
Visibility	Branded search, profile views, newsletter subscribers	Shortlists form before sales is involved
Trust	Case-study views before first call, reference requests	Buyers verify; proof shortens cycles
Pipeline	Inbound inquiries, lead-to-meeting rate	Smooths demand swings
Commercial	Discount frequency, win rate, share of packaged offers	Shows pricing power
Operational	Utilization variance, change requests billed	Protects margin

30-day demo content plan

A sample month that shows a consultancy exactly what to post, and on which day. It is a demo: swap the bracketed placeholders for your own niche, results and offer. All 30 days have an entry with the format, the exact topic, the idea and the opening line, and each week has one job in the buying journey.

WEEK 1 | AUTHORITY

Stand for something

Publish a clear point of view so buyers know what you are known for.

Days 1 to 7 | Works on: Problems 1, 7

WEEK 2 | TRUST

Show the proof

Lead with a real client result, with the number first.

Days 8 to 14 | Works on: Problems 2, 5, 8

WEEK 3 | EDUCATION

Teach and be transparent

Explain your method, your pricing logic and how you use AI.

Days 15 to 21 | Works on: Problems 2, 3, 5, 8

WEEK 4 | PIPELINE

Convert attention

Introduce a packaged offer and invite people into a conversation.

Days 22 to 28 | Works on: Problems 6, 7

What the month produces

9 Short videos, including one flagship case study	**6** Text posts on LinkedIn	**4** Newsletters, one per week
2 Carousels	**1** Live webinar	**1** Lead-magnet checklist

Plus 2 polls, 1 stat card and 4 weekly reshare days.

Ground rules

- **One niche, one outcome.** Everything in the month speaks to the same buyer about the same result.
- **Every piece ends with one call to action.** Reply, read the case, join the webinar, or book a call.
- **Record once, publish many times.** The Day 5 expert interview feeds the clips on Days 10 and 19.
- **Weekends stay light.** Saturday is a poll or a graphic, Sunday is a reshare plus batch recording. No new production on weekends.

Calendar, Week 1: Days 1 to 7

WEEK 1 | AUTHORITY
Stand for something

Publish a clear point of view so buyers know what you are known for.
Works on: Problems 1, 7

DAY 1 Mon	**LINKEDIN POST**	**AI made your deck cheaper. Here is what it cannot copy.** Short text post: name the shift, then list your three beliefs about what clients still pay for (judgment, accountability, sector depth). **Opening line:** *A polished strategy deck now takes an hour. So what are clients really paying for?*
DAY 2 Tue	**VIDEO 60s**	**Founder point of view on camera: what clients still pay for** One take, face to camera, captions on. Give one real example where your judgment changed a client's decision. **Opening line:** *Anyone can generate a strategy deck. Almost no one can tell you which option to kill.*
DAY 3 Wed	**CAROUSEL 8 slides**	**5 signs your advice is being commoditized** Slide 1 hook. Slides 2 to 6, one sign each: AI-discount requests, price-only comparisons, look-alike deliverables, hourly-rate asks, generic RFP scope. Slide 7 the fix, slide 8 call to action. **Opening line:** *If a client has ever asked you for an AI discount, read this.*
DAY 4 Thu	**NEWSLETTER #1**	**Your clients are fact-checking AI. Are they fact-checking you?** Expand Day 1 to about 500 words. Add one data point: 94% of B2B buyers fact-check AI research outputs (TrustRadius 2026). End with one question readers can reply to. **Opening line:** *Subject line: Your clients are fact-checking AI. Are they fact-checking you?*
DAY 5 Fri	**RECORD (not posted)**	**20-minute interview with your most senior expert** Ask three questions: Which decision would you never hand to AI? What nearly went wrong on your best project? What should juniors learn now? The recording feeds Days 10 and 19.
DAY 6 Sat	**POLL**	**What slows your buying decision most?** LinkedIn poll with four options: proving ROI, comparing firms, pricing, trusting the output. The winning answer shapes the content in Weeks 3 and 4. **Opening line:** *Buyers: what slows down your decision to hire a consultant?*
DAY 7 Sun	**RESHARE + BATCH**	**Reshare the week's best post with a new first line** Pick the post with the most comments, rewrite its first line and repost. Reply to every comment. Then script the Week 2 case-study video.

Calendar, Week 2: Days 8 to 14

WEEK 2 | TRUST
Show the proof

Lead with a real client result, with the number first.
Works on: Problems 2, 5, 8

DAY 8 Mon	**LINKEDIN POST**	**The result first: [metric] in [weeks]** Teaser for the flagship case study. One image with the number large, three lines of context, no jargon. **Opening line:** *[Client type] cut [metric] by [number] in [weeks]. Here is what we actually did.*
DAY 9 Tue	**VIDEO 90s**	**Flagship client case study** Client explains the problem (15 seconds), then three moves shown as on-screen steps, then the result with the number repeated. Link the written case in the comments. **Opening line:** *[Number] in [weeks]. Here is how.*
DAY 10 Wed	**VIDEO 45s**	**The decision that nearly went wrong** The consultant who led the project explains one judgment call and the thing that almost slipped. Cut from the Day 5 interview. It shows judgment, not just results. **Opening line:** *We almost recommended the wrong fix. Here is how we caught it.*
DAY 11 Thu	**NEWSLETTER #2**	**How [client type] got [result]: the full story** Situation, decision, result and three lessons, with the written one-pager attached. Close with one question for readers. **Opening line:** *Subject line: The result, the decision and the three lessons*
DAY 12 Fri	**VIDEO 30s + 10 DMs**	**One sentence from the client** The client says in their own words what changed. Then send the outreach message from the Sample scripts page to 10 people in a similar situation. **Opening line:** *On-screen text: "[Quote]", [Client name, role]*
DAY 13 Sat	**STAT CARD**	**Buyers trust colleagues more than consultants** One graphic: 82% of buyers trust coworkers and internal management, 59% trust consultants and experts (Search Engine Journal). Point: give buyers proof they can forward. **Opening line:** *Your buyer trusts their colleagues more than you. So give them something to forward.*
DAY 14 Sun	**RESHARE + BATCH**	**Reshare the case-study video with a new hook** Repost the Day 9 video with a new first line and reply to every comment. Then record the Week 3 videos in one session.

Calendar, Week 3: Days 15 to 21

WEEK 3 | EDUCATION

Teach and be transparent

Explain your method, your pricing logic and how you use AI.

Works on: Problems 2, 3, 5, 8

DAY 15 Mon	**LINKEDIN POST**	**How we use AI on client work, and how we check it** Plain-English post: where AI helps, who verifies the output and what is never automated. Link it to a short trust page on your site. **Opening line:** *Yes, we use AI. Here is exactly where, and who checks it.*
DAY 16 Tue	**VIDEO 45s**	**Our method in 45 seconds** Animated explainer of your named 3 to 5 step framework with one signature diagram. Reuse it in every proposal. **Opening line:** *Every engagement we run follows the same four steps.*
DAY 17 Wed	**CAROUSEL 7 slides**	**Hourly, fixed fee or outcome-based: what are you buying?** One slide per pricing model showing who carries the delivery risk (client, shared, firm), then a slide on how to choose. **Opening line:** *Three ways to buy consulting. Only one lets you judge the result.*
DAY 18 Thu	**NEWSLETTER #3 + LEAD MAGNET**	**10 questions to ask before you scale AI** Launch a one-page AI readiness and governance checklist, gated by email. Explain how to score the answers. **Opening line:** *Subject line: The 10 questions most AI projects skip*
DAY 19 Fri	**VIDEO 45s + WEBINAR INVITE**	**The decision I would never hand to AI** Clip from the Day 5 interview. Add the webinar date and sign-up link on screen. **Opening line:** *After [X] years in this work, here is the one decision I still make by hand.*
DAY 20 Sat	**POLL**	**Does your adviser tell you how they use AI?** Four options: yes clearly, sort of, no, not sure. Use the result in the Day 24 webinar. **Opening line:** *Be honest: do you know how your advisers use AI on your work?*
DAY 21 Sun	**RESHARE + BATCH**	**Reshare the pricing carousel** Repost Day 17 with a new first line. Then draft the webinar: three buyer questions, one demo, live Q and A.

Calendar, Week 4: Days 22 to 28

WEEK 4 | PIPELINE
Convert attention

Introduce a packaged offer and invite people into a conversation.
Works on: Problems 6, 7

DAY 22 Mon	**LINKEDIN POST**	**Introducing the 2-week [Outcome] Sprint** Announce a packaged offer: who it is for, what is delivered, the fixed price range and what is excluded. **Opening line:** *Not every problem needs a six-month engagement. This one takes two weeks.*
DAY 23 Tue	**VIDEO 60s**	**What happens in the sprint, day by day** Screen-share a sample deliverable and walk through the week-one and week-two plan. **Opening line:** *Here is what you will hold in your hands on day 10.*
DAY 24 Wed	**WEBINAR 30 min**	**Three questions buyers ask about AI and pricing** Answer the top three questions from your polls, take 10 minutes of live Q and A, share the checklist and end with the fit-call link. **Opening line:** *Free, 30 minutes, no pitch deck.*
DAY 25 Thu	**NEWSLETTER #4**	**What we covered live, and the slides** Recap with a replay clip, the checklist and the sprint offer. Close with a book-a-call link. **Opening line:** *Subject line: The replay, the slides and the checklist*
DAY 26 Fri	**VIDEO 30s**	**Who we call when the problem is bigger than us** Introduce a complementary specialist partner (with their permission) and explain how you team up. It answers the rise of boutiques and independents. **Opening line:** *We do not do everything. Here is who we call.*
DAY 27 Sat	**LINKEDIN POST**	**Ask me anything about [niche]** Open-question post. Collect questions in the comments and answer the best five on video on Day 30. **Opening line:** *Ask me anything about [niche]. I will answer the best five on video.*
DAY 28 Sun	**RESHARE + BATCH**	**Reshare the sprint announcement from a new angle** Repost Day 22 with a client problem it solves as the first line. Then message everyone who attended or engaged this week.

Calendar, Days 29 and 30: close the month

DAY 29 Mon	**LINKEDIN POST**	**What we learned from 30 days of publishing in public** Three lessons plus honest numbers: conversations started, calls booked and what flopped. **Opening line:** *30 days, [n] conversations, [n] calls. What worked and what did not.*
DAY 30 Tue	**VIDEO 60s + REVIEW**	**Answers to your top three questions** Answer the best questions from Day 27 on camera. Then run the month review below and pick next month's niche question. **Opening line:** *You asked. Here are the answers.*

Month review (run on Day 30)

Question	Why it matters
Which three pieces started the most conversations?	Replies and DMs matter more than likes and views.
Which format earned replies, not just views?	Double down on it next month.
How many calls were booked, and from which piece?	Shows which topic is closest to a buying decision.
Which questions kept coming up?	They become next month's content and your next report.
What will you repeat, change or drop?	Keep the weekly structure, swap the topics.

How to adapt it

- Swap the point of view and the case study for your own. The structure matters more than the exact titles.
- If your audience is small, keep the posting days but cut to five videos, and replace the Day 24 webinar with a recorded Q and A video.
- If you have no client result you can share yet, use an anonymized project or a pilot and be clear about it.
- Month two: turn the questions from Day 27 into a data-led report, which is the hardest asset for competitors to copy.

Sample scripts and briefs

Three of the month's most important pieces, written as short briefs. Bracketed text is a placeholder.

Day 2 · Founder point of view video (60 seconds)

Hook: "Everyone can now make a polished strategy deck in an hour. So why would a client still pay you?"

Outline

1. Name the shift in one sentence: AI has made polished output cheap.
2. State your stance: clients now pay for judgment they can verify.
3. Give one example from your own work where judgment changed the decision.
4. Close with one question to the viewer: what would you still pay an adviser for?

Call to action: Ask viewers to reply with their answer; follow every reply with a short message.

Day 9 · Flagship client case study (90 seconds)

Hook: "[Client] cut [metric] by [number] in [weeks]. Here is exactly how."

Outline

1. Put the result on screen in the first three seconds.
2. Client explains the problem in their own words (15 seconds).
3. Three moves you made, shown with simple on-screen steps.
4. Client states what changed for the business; add the number again.

Call to action: Link the written case study and invite a 20 minute call to compare situations.

Day 23 · Sprint walkthrough (60 seconds)

Hook: "Want [outcome] without a six-month engagement? This is the 2-week version."

Outline

1. Who it is for, in one line.
2. What happens in week one and week two.
3. Show a sample deliverable on screen.
4. State the fixed price and what is excluded.

Call to action: Invite viewers to the webinar or to book a 20 minute fit call.

Warm outreach message (use from Day 12)

Hi [Name], I saw your note on [topic]. We just published a short case study on how [client type] cut [metric] by [number]. Happy to send it over, and I would be curious how you are handling this at [Company]. No pitch, just a comparison of notes.

Running the month and measuring it

Six steps to run the plan

1. **Pick one niche and one outcome**
   Decide who the month speaks to and what result you want them to associate with you.
2. **Record in two batches**
   One interview day and one filming day cover most of the month's video.
3. **Edit once, publish many times**
   Each long recording becomes a short clip, a quote graphic and a newsletter excerpt.
4. **Publish on a fixed rhythm**
   Same days, same times. Consistency matters more than any single post.
5. **Start conversations**
   Use the routine and DM template to turn viewers into discovery calls.
6. **Review and repeat**
   Keep what started conversations; drop what only earned reactions.

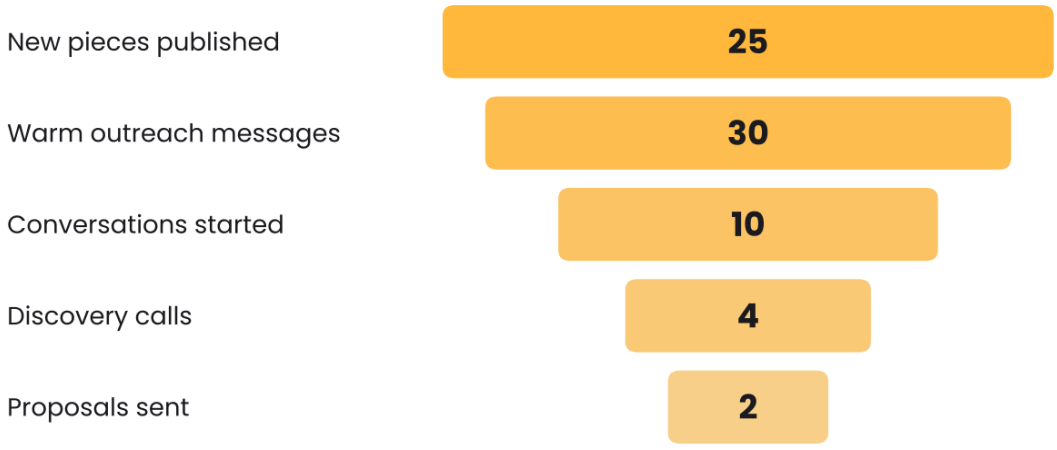
The weekly engagement routine

Daily, 15 minutes	Comment thoughtfully on five posts from target clients; send five connection requests with a personal note; answer every comment within 24 hours.
Friday, 30 minutes	Message everyone who engaged twice or more. Offer one useful resource, not a pitch.
Sunday, 60 minutes	Reshare the week's best post, count conversations started (not likes), then batch-record next week's videos.
Day 30	Run the month review: top three pieces by conversations, what to repeat, and next month's niche question.

What success could look like

These are illustrative targets for a firm with a small starting audience, not benchmarks. Judge the month by conversations and calls, not by views.

Illustrative month-one targets for a firm starting with a small audience



Method and sources

How to read this report

- Research was conducted in October 2026 through web research across industry publications, analyst commentary, vendor reports and practitioner posts.
- Many figures are **secondary**: a blog or press release citing a study, not the study itself. Each statistic names its origin, and the originals may show different wording or scope.
- Some sources are vendors or agencies with a commercial interest (for example lead-generation and marketing firms). Treat their claims as directional.
- The Hinge findings about high-growth firms are correlations. They show what top performers do, not that the activity alone causes growth.
- The problem map scores and every solution playbook are Motionholic editorial recommendations, not research findings.
- The 2024 Grist thought-leadership figures are older than the rest and are labelled as such.

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Turn the playbooks into content people watch

Motionholic edits the case-study videos, expert clips, explainers and motion-graphic frameworks this report recommends.

What we make for consultancies

- Client case-study videos with metrics on screen
- Expert interview cut-downs for LinkedIn and email
- Animated framework and methodology explainers
- Talking-head thought-leadership series
- Report launch trailers and webinar promos

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